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# PetPet

PetPet is a PETSCII editor for Commodore 64 computers. As it is written entirely in Python, it runs on any platform supported by Python (Windows, MacOS, Linux and others).

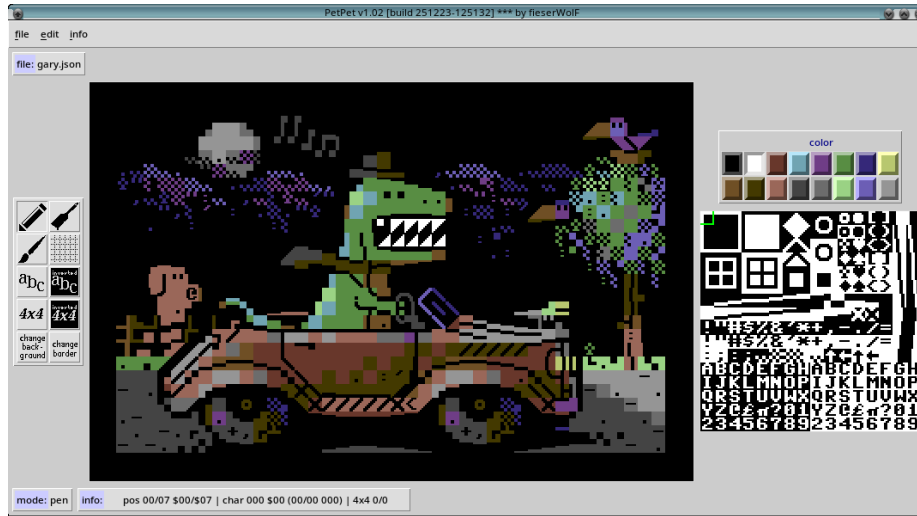


Figure 1: screenshot

## Why PetPet?

| reason   | description                                                                  |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| script   | no compiling, easy to modify import and export to your needs                 |
| portable | available on Linux, MacOS, Windows and any other system supported by Python3 |

## Author

- fieserWolf/Abyss-Connection - *initial work* - <https://github.com/fieserWolf> <https://csdb.dk/scener/?id=3623>

## Acknowledgements

- Logiker for testing and feature ideas
- Mermaid for the still wonderful PETSCII entitled “Gary”

## Using PetPet

### shortcuts

| key         | function               |
|-------------|------------------------|
| Alt-q       | quit                   |
| Alt-o       | open PETSCII (json)    |
| Alt-s       | save PETSCII (json)    |
| Ctrl-s      | save PETSCII (json)    |
| Alt-Shift-s | save PETSCII (json) as |
| Alt-g       | toggle grid            |
| Ctrl-z      | undo                   |
| Ctrl-x      | cut                    |
| Ctrl-c      | copy                   |
| Ctrl-v      | paste                  |

### drawing modes

Use left mouse-button to draw. These are the drawing modes:

| mode               | description                                                                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| pen                | draw characters and colors                                                          |
| brush              | draw only colors                                                                    |
| pencil             | draw only characters                                                                |
| writemode          | type characters on your keyboard directly at mouse position                         |
| inverted writemode | type inverted characters on your keyboard directly at mouse position                |
| 4x4                | draw 4x4 pixels freely with your mouse                                              |
| inverted 4x4       | draw inverted 4x4 pixels freely with your mouse                                     |
| set bg             | choose a color, then click into the picture to change the background color (\$d021) |
| set border         | choose a color, then click into the picture to change the border color (\$d020)     |

### cut, copy and paste

Use right mouse-button to select an area. Then, use the usual hotkeys (STRG+X, STRG+C, STRG+V) to cut, copy and paste.

## How to change the color-palette

The default palette is PEPTO. You can change the color-palette for previewing on your PC in your own configuration-file. In this JSON file you can edit the “palette” array. See section “PetPet JSON configuration format”.

## How to change the layout

You can change the layout of the available characters in your own configuration-file. In this JSON file you can edit the “layout” array. See section “PetPet JSON configuration format”.

Example layouts:



Figure 2: layout1

## Commandline options

PetPet v1.00 REVISION PARTY 2025 [19.04.2025] \*\*\* by fieserWolf

usage: petpet.py [-h] [-p PETSCII\_FILENAME] [-c CONFIG\_FILENAME] [-f FONT\_FILENAME]

This is a PETSCII editor. Press F1 for help in the program.

options:

```
-h, --help            show this help message and exit
-p, --petSCII_file PETSCII_FILENAME
                        petSCII filename (.json)
-c, --config_file CONFIG_FILENAME
                        name of configuration file (.json)
```



Figure 3: layout2

```
-f, --font_file FONT_FILENAME
                        name of font (2048 bytes)
```

Example: `./petpet.py -p gfx.json -c config.json -f font.bin`

## Getting Started

Petpet comes in two flavors:

- standalone executable for 64-bit systems Linux and Windows (see releases)
- Python3 script

### Run the standalone executable

Just download your bundle at releases, extract the zip file and enjoy.

### Run the Python3 script directly

#### Install Python

**Prerequisites** Python3 is needed to run PetPet. Everything else needed should be provided in your Python3 installation by default:

- json
- tkinter
- argparse

#### Install Python on Windows or Mac

- Download Python from <https://www.python.org>.
- Install Python on your computer.

**Install Python on Linux** On my Debian GNU/Linux machine I use apt to install everything needed:

```
apt update  
apt install python3 python3-tk
```

Alternatively, you can use pip to install missing modules:

```
pip3 install argparse json
```

#### Download PetPet

- Go to <https://github.com/fieserWolf/petpet>.
- Click on the green “Code” button and “Download ZIP”.
- Extract the downloaded ZIP-file to any folder.

## File Formats

The PETSCII image is natively stored as a json file. There is also a binary import and export.

### PetPet JSON format

| object   | key        | type                  | value              |
|----------|------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| info     | program    | string                | “PetPet”           |
| info     | version    | string                | e.g. “1.0”         |
| settings | background | number                | color 0-15         |
| settings | border     | number                | color 0-15         |
| settings | font       | string                | filename of font   |
| settings | grid       | boolean               | True or False      |
| .        | char       | array of 1000 numbers | characters (0-255) |
| .        | color      | array of 1000 numbers | colors (0-15)      |

### binary format

You can customize this to your own needs in code/action.py in the functions load\_petscii\_bin() and save\_petscii\_bin() .

| offset | size in bytes | value            |
|--------|---------------|------------------|
| 0      | 1000          | characters       |
| 1000   | 1000          | colors           |
| 1001   | 1             | background color |
| 1002   | 1             | border color     |

### PETSCII-EDITOR binary format

Use this to exchange images with my native C64 tool “Petscii-Editor” ( see <https://csdb.dk/release/?id=155723> ).

| offset | size in bytes | value                            |
|--------|---------------|----------------------------------|
| 0      | 2             | start address \$3000 (low, high) |
| 2      | 1000          | characters                       |
| 1002   | 1             | border color                     |
| 1003   | 1             | background color                 |
| 1004   | 1             | \$d018 value (\$14 or \$16)      |
| 1026   | 1000          | colors                           |



## PetPet JSON configuration format

| object   | key        | type                     | value                                                                                 |
|----------|------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| info     | program    | string                   | “PetPet”                                                                              |
| info     | version    | string                   | e.g. “1.0”                                                                            |
| settings | background | number                   | color 0-15                                                                            |
| settings | border     | number                   | color 0-15                                                                            |
| settings | font       | string                   | filename of font                                                                      |
| settings | grid       | boolean                  | True or False                                                                         |
| .        | palette    | array of 16*3<br>numbers | red, green, blue<br>value for each<br>C64 color<br>(default: PEPTO<br>colors) (0-255) |
| .        | layout     | array of 256<br>numbers  | characters (0-255)                                                                    |

# Changelog

## Future plans

Any help and support in any form is highly appreciated.

If you have a feature request, a bug report or if you want to offer help, please, contact me:

<http://csdb.dk/scener/?id=3623> or [wolf@abyss-connection.de](mailto:wolf@abyss-connection.de)

## Changes in 1.03

(next release candidate)

- improved GUI
- mouse wheel in drawing window zooms in and out
- added “open config” menu item
- added layout for dirart “config\_dirart.json” (with restricted character-set)
- added “import screen only” and “export screen only”
- added “import petmate” and “export petmate” (petmate9 support)
- added “reverse pen”

## Changes in 1.02

- improved undo
- character selection preview in selected color (thanks, Groepaz!)
- image-preview export for PC (PPM format)
- improved documentation
- new mode: inverted writemode
- new mode: 4x4 mode (just draw with your mouse)
- new mode: inverted 4x4 mode
- improved help
- new about infowindow
- various bug-fixes

## Changes in 1.01

- improved selection box
- added write-mode
- gui improvements
- export to C64 executable
- improved documentation

## Changes in 1.0

released on REVISION PARTY 2025

- initial release

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For further questions, please contact me at <http://csdb.dk/scener/?id=3623> or [wolf@abyss-connection.de](mailto:wolf@abyss-connection.de)

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*Version 3, 29 June 2007*

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### **argparse**

<https://github.com/bewest/argparse> library used

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## History

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